had to be on our toes all the time and find solutions. It gives good training on how to face life itself because it's never a straight and even path. There are so many ups and downs.

In the first year, we also had a week-long camp called *Gita Shivir*. We were taken to an ashram in Vadodara run by a renowned Swamiji, who gave us a lot of deep insights into the teachings of the Gita, which is a great tool for management students and leaders. It was a unique experience—staying in a rural environment on the outskirts of Vadodara and listening to the lessons of Swamiji under the open sky, something a B-school student is unlikely to experience. Later in my life, the meditation lesson learnt at the *Gita Shivir* helped me keep my composure when faced with unwarranted public attacks by so-called intellectuals, as I, in my avatar as a historian, did not conform to their narratives. And the ADMAP training helps me stand in good stead in every crisis.

At the end of the first year, we were introduced to a unique concept called Development of Corporate Citizenship (DoCC). We all had to do a two-month-long internship with an NGO to understand the social needs, how the unstructured environment functions and to help the NGO structure its work by sharing with it some managerial concepts that we had learnt as part of our pedagogy.

I joined Bengaluru-based Janaagraha Centre for Citizenship and Democracy, which was started by Swati Ramanathan and Ramesh Ramanathan in 2001. It felt nice to help them with a lot of course material for the civic training they were conducting in schools. At that time, it may have sounded irrelevant to me—as most students think of what they are taught—but in the hindsight, I can say that it actually helped me shape up as a mature individual and face different challenges of life.

In the first year, we were exposed to all branches of management and in the second year, we specialised in our major. We also had to take a minor, and I went for information management. The course ended with a two-month internship. I did mine at GE Capital, and got a job there.

The training at BITS Pilani and SPJIMR empowered me with an analytical bent of mind that keeps me in good stead, especially while following a discipline such as history that I eventually branched out to. This analytical way of looking at information helps me structure it better for my research. But more importantly, the SPJIMR made me socially responsible. Very few institutes invest time and energy to make the concept of being sensitive to society a regular part of their pedagogy. The SPJIMR does, and it makes an indelible positive mark on young minds, growing up to become conscious citizens of this country. ■

The writer is a historian and author of eight books. His latest book is Bravehearts of Bharat: Vignettes from Indian History. *He graduated from SPJIMR in 2005*

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